Engineering & Applied Science
UNIVERSITY OF COLORADO **BOULDER**

T3am Thr33: Smart-Tongs

A Food-Waste Reduction Product

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How Might We Reduce Food Waste?

***Define**: Students Need a way to be mindful of their consumption habits.*

- *It's too easy to take more food than you can eat*
- *Leftovers end up getting wasted*
- *Current consumption habits are not sustainable*

***Ideate**: How can we effectively influence consumption habits.*

Qualitative:

- Ease of use
- Easy to understand feedback
- Simple to understand how to use

Quantitative:

- Able to handle a grip of 125 lbs of force)
- Spring constant k = 1 N/mm to not be too strong or weak

Functional:

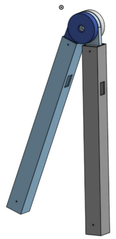
- Able to open and close well.
- Able to pick up all possible food with relative ease.
- Able to provide feedback.

Bill of Materials

Name:	Material:	Price:
Hinge	ABS plastic	ABS price
User feedback	Mixed	$16.00
Grippers	ABS plastic	ABS price
Rumble Motors	Mixed	$7.52
PCB	PCB	$96.00
SSD 1306 Display	Mixed	$7.36
Box Extrusion	Aluminum 6061	$21.88
Accelerometer mpu6050	Mixed	$10.99
Custom Circuit Boards	Fiberglass	$91.58
ABS Filiment	ABS plastic	$23.00

***The Concept:** Smart-Tongs that provide consumption feedback.*

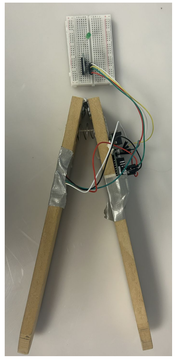
- **Record Serving Size**
  - Live-Axle / Sensor Measured Hinge
  - Inertial Measurement Unit (Movement Sensor)
  - 240 Mhz Dual Core Processor
- **Report Excessive Consumption**
  - Micro OLED-Display
  - Rumble Motor
  - Piezo Element Buzzer
- **Relay Consumption Statistics to Base**
  - Wireless Connectivity over WIFI
  - 2.4GHz Short Range Antenna
  - Bluetooth-LE Support



Prototype Progression

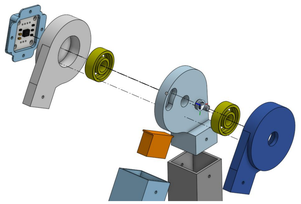
***REV 0-1**: Pretotypes*

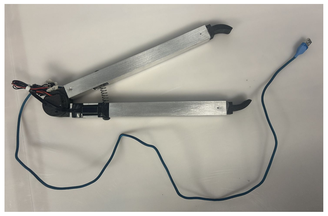
- *Quick and Simple*

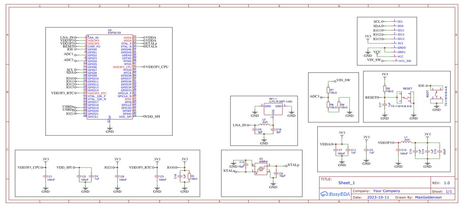


***REV 2**: Feature Complete Prototype*

- *Measures Consumption*
- *Reports Feedback*

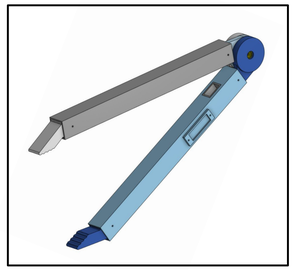


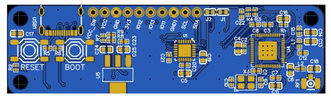




***REV 3**: High Fidelity Prototype*

- *Fully Functional*
- *Wireless Connectivity*
- *Internal Battery*
- *Custom Circuit Board*





Analysis: Tongs and Team

Team Growth

- Each team member has grown their skills in specific areas such as coding, CAD, or machining as the project has progressed.
- Understanding teammates' strengths and weaknesses.
- Communication skills have improved, teamwork with other engineers has become more natural.
- Understanding of the design process of projects.

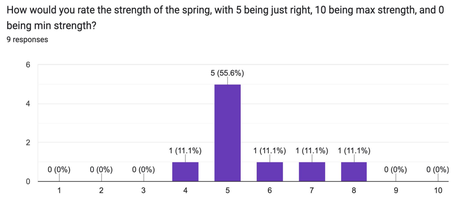
Future Work

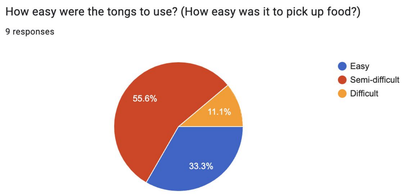
Digitalizing the way we serve ourselves food, while making people aware of the consequences of our actions to our environment.

To take the product further, ideas of other kitchen utensils have been considered, such as ladles, serving spoons, or plates.

Testing Results:

To test the product, we are using multiple tongs, one set with user feedback and one without, in order to determine whether or not the user feedback aided in the mitigation of food waste.





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